in a silent parade from Lisbon's city hall to the cathedral, escorting the relics of St. Francis Xavier'.[8] Vassalo e Silva returned home to a hostile reception. Salazar had him court-martialed and then exiled. I must admit that I feel somewhat sorry for the last colonial.

Reading press reports about the liberation of Goa half a century after the event, I was struck by the extreme hostility with which Western diplomats and media of that time reacted to Indian actions. The United States and Britain pushed for a UN resolution against India, but it was vetoed by the USSR. Press reports railed against Indian aggression and shed many a tear for Goa's Christians, ignoring the fact that leading pro-liberation activists like Tristão de Braganza Cunha were themselves Christian.[9] A *Time* magazine article 'India: End of an Image' dated 29 December 1961, openly called Nehru a hypocrite who preached peace abroad but used force at home. The magazine appears not to have noticed that after waiting for fourteen years for the Portuguese to come to the table, the Prime Minister was looking increasingly ridiculous.

DUELS WITH THE DRAGON

Taking Goa from a spent power like Portugal was one thing, but it was quite another to deal with Mao's China. The Sino–Indian border can be divided into two sectors. In the east, it is defined by the McMohan Line which had been agreed upon between the Tibetans and the British as per the Simla Agreement of 1914. It was named after Sir Arthur Henry McMohan who was the chief negotiator for the British side. It generally followed the crest of the Himalayan range eastwards from Tawang near the Bhutan tri-border and defined the northern boundary of the North East Frontier Agency[10] (what we now know as the state of Arunachal Pradesh). An early version of the Line had also been endorsed by a Chinese representative, but the final detailed version was signed only by Tibet and British India.

In the middle Himalayas, India and China were separated by three kingdoms—Nepal, Bhutan and Sikkim (the last was then an Indian